

Early games



Coders have been making games since the early days of computing. All the games we play need code, whether played on a computer, a television, or a cellphone. These images look simple now, but when they were created they were groundbreaking!

Atari 2600

The Atari 2600 was one of the earliest and most popular gaming systems sold for home use, from 1977. Games were small, rectangular plastic boxes that slotted into the box, called a console.

The controls had joysticks for movement and a single “fire” button.



PONG

Pong was created in 1972 by Atari. Two players used paddles with rotating knobs to bounce a “ball” back and forth. A point was scored when the other player missed the ball. There were two versions: an arcade game and one that attached to a television.



SPACE INVADERS

One of the earliest arcade games was Space Invaders, released in 1978. Aliens moved across the sky, and the player fired missiles up at them to try to stop the aliens from landing.



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